

Throwbacks and pullbacks. A throwback or pullback occurs about 60% of the time, which is a little low compared to other chart pattern types (which average about 66%). It takes, on average, 11 days for the stock to return to the breakout price. Throwbacks and pullbacks hurt performance, which is a trend we see in many other chart pattern types.

After a throwback or pullback completes, price resumes trending in the breakout direction most of the time except after downward breakouts in bear markets where price rises 57% of the time (it continues lower 43% of the time).

Gaps. The two outer columns (the trend followers) prefer patterns with no gaps for better performance. Countertrend patterns (the two inner columns) show patterns with gaps have better performance. Because the performance difference in most columns is only one percentage point, I wouldn't lose any sleep over these results.

[Table 56.5](#) shows pattern size statistics.